

Frontend Visual Design Guide

Presentation-quality handoff for React and shadcn implementation: tokens, usage rules, type hierarchy, component patterns, screen blueprints, states, responsive behavior, and QA criteria.

- DARK FIRST

LIGHT SPECIFIED

SHADCN/UI

LUCIDE

RADIUS 0

DOCUMENT MAP

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01	Components	Primitives, states, overlays
02	Patterns	Screens, responsive, build contract

CONSOLE SPECIMEN

ACADEMY CONSOLE SPECIMEN

CHECKPOINT 04 / 78%

CATALOG

STORY

LESSON

PROGRESS

ACTIVE PATH

Logic under pressure

The guide itself demonstrates the Academy UI language: compact, sharp, useful, and never decorative for its own sake.

FOUNDATION

Night City at a desk job

Operational, dense, sharp, and legible. This is a learning instrument panel, not a course marketplace, brochure, or generic SaaS dashboard.

SQUARE GEOMETRY

Radius is 0; notches are rare emphasis.

CYAN DOES WORK

Primary actions, focus, active nav, progress.

MONO MEANS SYSTEM

Labels, metadata, state, telemetry, code.

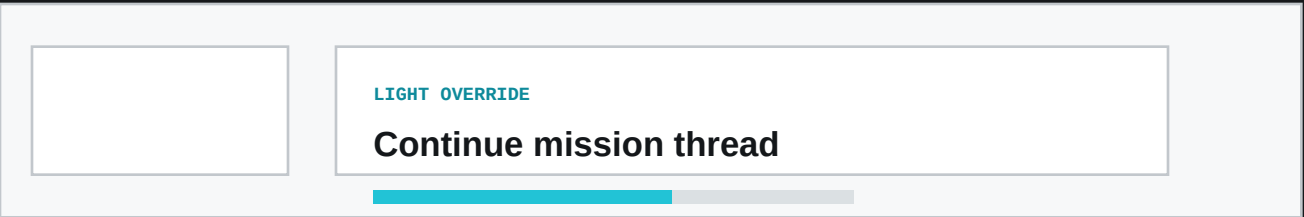
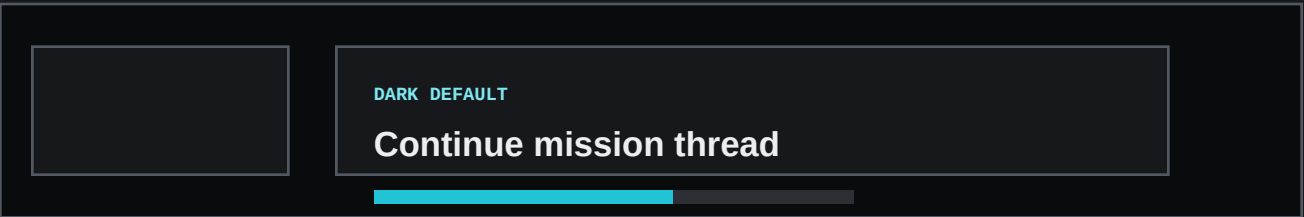
NO EMPTY THEATRE

Compact panels, rows, grids, anchored controls.

THEMES

Dark and light are both specified

Dark is the default product experience. Light mode remaps surfaces and text while preserving cyan, volt, magenta, success, and destructive meanings.



TYPOGRAPHY

Archivo reads; IBM Plex Mono reports

No viewport-scaled type. No negative body tracking. Use mono only for labels, status, data, code, and compact controls.

HERO	Archivo Bold 56/60
H1	Archivo Bold 42/44
H2	Archivo Semibold 32/37
BODY	Archivo Regular 15/24
LABEL	IBM Plex Mono 12/14
CODE	IBM Plex Mono 13/20

Paint chips and semantic ownership

Every color has an owner. Engineers should choose semantic tokens, not nearby hues or one-off values.

--gray-950
#0A0B0C
Page canvas
Deepest app background.

--gray-900
#101214
Shell
Sidebar and topbar.

--gray-850
#16181B
Cards
Default repeated item.

--gray-800
#1C1F23
Hover fill
Interactive hover.

--gray-700
#2A2E33
Borders
Strong dividers.

--gray-500
#5C646D
Muted
Secondary text.

--gray-100
#ECEEF1
Dark text
Primary on dark.

--gray-50
#F7F8F9
Light bg
Light canvas.

--cyan-500
#22C3D6
Primary
CTA, focus, progress.

--cyan-600
#14A5B8
Pressed
Pressed/light primary.

--volt-500
#D4B52E
Decision
Choice/caution.

--mag-500
#CF3F9A
Story
Narrative signal.

--green-400
#46C97E
Success
Passed/completed.

--red-500
#E14B4B
Danger
Errors/destructive.

--surface-raised
#FFFFFF
Light card
Light panels.

--light-text
#14171A
Light text
Primary on light.

--volt-300
#F0DD7C
Volt fg
Readable warning fg.

--cyan-300
#7EE7F0
Cyan fg
Readable accent fg.

shadcn primitives, Academy variants

Use shadcn for behavior and accessibility; Academy tokens define visual identity, density, states, and usage.

ACTIONS

RESUME

HOVER

FOCUS

SECONDARY

RESET

LOCKED

ACTIVE PATH

DECISION

STORY BEAT

PASSED

FAILED

LOCKED

PROGRESS

Square tracks paired with visible mono value: 62%, 04/11, passed 8/10.

LUCIDE ICONS

Play, Check, X, AlertTriangle, Lock, Search, Filter, ChevronDown, Terminal, BookOpen, Route, Trophy, Share2.

FORMS

EMAIL ADDRESS

learner@presstronic.dev

CALLSIGN

NOVA-17

ACCESS CODE

Expired token

DIFFICULTY

Operator / ChevronDown

VALIDATION

Red border, red helper copy, error icon, and concrete recovery language.

SURFACES

CATALOG

LESSONS

STORY

CERTS

COURSE CARD

Systems Thinking Under Load

Hover changes border and fill only. No lift. No card inside a card.

States, overlays, shell, and screen blueprints

The engineering handoff: required states, shell geometry, screen families, responsive rules, and React component mapping.

STATE MATRIX

DEFAULT	neutral border + readable content	HOVER	border/fill change, no lift
FOCUS	2px cyan outline	ACTIVE	pressed fill or selected rail
DISABLED	dim but legible; explain why	LOADING	skeleton or mono progress text
EMPTY	nearest action + one CTA	SUCCESS	green state + concrete result
WARNING	volt state + decision language	ERROR	red state + recovery copy

OVERLAYS

CONFIRM RESET

Blocking dialog with 65% black scrim.

CHECKPOINT SAVED
Bottom-center toast.

Explain unfamiliar icons briefly.

SHELL AND SCREEN FAMILIES

264PX RAIL

Dense grids, anchored controls, stable tiles.

CATALOG required regions + states	ONBOARDING required regions + states	STORY required regions + states
LESSON required regions + states	PROGRESSION required regions + states	CERTIFICATE required regions + states